For next week:

Register as an equipment room patron (asap, it takes a beat before you are added), and place a reservation to check out a hard drive to bring to class on Thursday, October 16.

Contacts/how to get help:

Rachel's email: rjames@barnard.edu
Media Center website: mediacenter.barnard.edu

Links to the examples we watched in class:

Ruth Asawa: documentary on an artist who worked every minute | HOW TO SEE
Dir. Sarah Cowan, 2026
Choice Thoughts: Reflections on the Birth Control War
Dir. Jacqueline Frank, 1996
Chinnabhumi — The Shattered Land
Dir. Arin Paul, 2026

Where you can locate media for your projects:

It bears mentioning a fabulous libguide from Barnard librarian Meredith Wisner, this one includes an entire section on places to stream open access/open source materials.

Here are some of my recommendations:

A good place to start – search engines, large repositories, and other useful tools:

https://search.creativecommons.org/

archive.org

ArchiveGrid
A handy site for searching through existing digital archives across multiple sources. Not comprehensive, but an excellent place to start.

Digital Public Library of America

Search the digital collections of thousands of libraries, archives, and museums nationwide, all in one website.

Library of Congress

Their digital collections include many copyright-free historical films with digital download capabilities.

Worth pointing out:

Barnard Archives very own Digital Collections

The New York City Municipal Archives Digital Collections

A great place to find original blueprints and records of spaces in New York City.

New York Historical Society's Digital Collections

Music:

In addition to searching audio archives and creative commons databases above, I recommend The Free Music Archive to search for music to incorporate into your videos.

Deeper Dive:

https://www.gothamcenter.org/resources/archives

A comprehensive list of archives in New York City, some which have digital collections you may be able to utilize in your work, most especially if it relates strongly to your topic. Some on this list have extensive digital archive collections that may be valuable for you to pull from.

Every institution has its own policies, but it never hurts to send an email outlining your project and interest in utilizing the archives for this piece of research.

If nothing else, consider exploring these archives as a jumping off point for inspiration, and types of footage you might find elsewhere.

What to consider when Sourcing archival footage:

Barnard library has a fabulous [LibGuide explaining Creative Commons and Intellectual Property]() to help you with any questions re: your sourcing.

[Link to an explainer on the different Creative Commons Licenses]().

When searching for CC licensed work, you want to be sure you can ‘modify and adapt’ and/or remix the content for your purposes.

Anything with expired or nonexistent licensing is referred to as Public Domain and there are no restrictions.

Not necessary for this class, but of note: It has been legally determined that anything in the ‘public domain’ is fair game, as long as you are creating a meaningful alteration of the work that provides commentary or secondary meaning, as opposed to duplicating. This has been typically represented in the 10-20% range – if you can only recognize 10% of the original content, and have created a meaningful alteration to its meaning, you can argue for its use.

Always make note of where you found something: cite your sources.

